



USER DOCUMENTATION

Mpeli Outfit Store

Clothing Shop Management System — A practical guide for the store Owner (Admin) and Sellers on using the system every day.

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MPELI OUTFIT STORE

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1 About This Guide

This manual explains how to use the Mpeli Outfit Store clothing shop management system in your day-to-day work. No programming or technical knowledge is required.

The system is used by two types of users:

Role	Who is it?	Main responsibilities
OWNER	The shop owner / administrator	Full control: products, prices, promotions, inventory, users, settings, all reports and finances.
SELLER	Store employees / sales staff	Selling at the counter, recording expenses they make, and viewing their own sales and reports.

Throughout this guide, features that are only available to the **Owner** are marked with **OWNER**. Features available to everyone are marked with **ALL**.

How to use this guide: Start with Sections 5 and 6 if you are setting up the system for the first time. Sections 9 and 10 cover the two most common daily tasks — adding products and selling. Use the Table of Contents to jump to any topic.

2 System Overview

One calm internal dashboard that helps you track stock, sales, expenses, and profit from a single place.

Mpeli Outfit Store is a web-based management system built specifically for a clothing boutique. It runs in the web browser and stores all information in a database, so nothing is kept on individual computers. The system is available in **English** and **Swahili**.

What the system helps you do

Area	What you can do
Products	Add, edit, and remove products with buying price, selling price, minimum allowed selling price, stock quantity, and an optional product image.
Sales	Sell items at the counter (Sales POS), apply bulk discounts, choose a payment method, and complete the sale.
Promotions	Create percentage discounts that run between a start and an end date/time, and control which products are discounted.
Inventory	See total stock, low-stock items, and out-of-stock items at a glance. Stock is reduced automatically after every sale.
Expenses	Record shop expenses (rent, transport, electricity, salaries, and more) with category and date.
Reports	View sales, revenue, expenses, and profit for today, this week, this month, or this year — and download reports as PDF or Excel (XLSX).
Users	Create and manage Seller accounts so employees can sign in with their own identity.
Settings	Set the shop name, address, phone, currency, low-stock threshold, receipt footer, dark mode, and maintenance mode.

Important: The exact screens you see depend on your role. Sellers see a smaller set of options; the Owner sees everything.

3 System Requirements

To use the system you only need a web browser and access to the store's address (URL). The system itself is installed on the store's server.

Requirements for users

- A computer, laptop, or tablet connected to the same network (or the internet) where the system is hosted.
- Any modern web browser: **Google Chrome**, **Microsoft Edge**, **Mozilla Firefox**, or **Safari**.
- A display wide enough to use the side menu comfortably (the system also works on smaller/mobile screens).

Technical environment (for the person hosting the system)

Component	Requirement
Web server	Apache with <code>mod_rewrite</code> enabled
PHP	Version 8.0 or newer
Database	MySQL 5.7+ or MariaDB 10.3+
Browser	A modern, up-to-date browser (see above)

Note: If any part of the server setup is not correct, the system shows a **System Health Check** screen instead of the login page. See Section 18 (Troubleshooting) for details.

4 Accessing the System

Open the system in your web browser by typing the store's address.

1. Open your web browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox, or Safari).
2. In the address bar, type the address given to you by the Owner or the IT person — for example `http://localhost/MpeliOutFitStore/` if the system runs on this computer.
3. Press **Enter**. The **Mpeli Outfit Store** login screen appears.

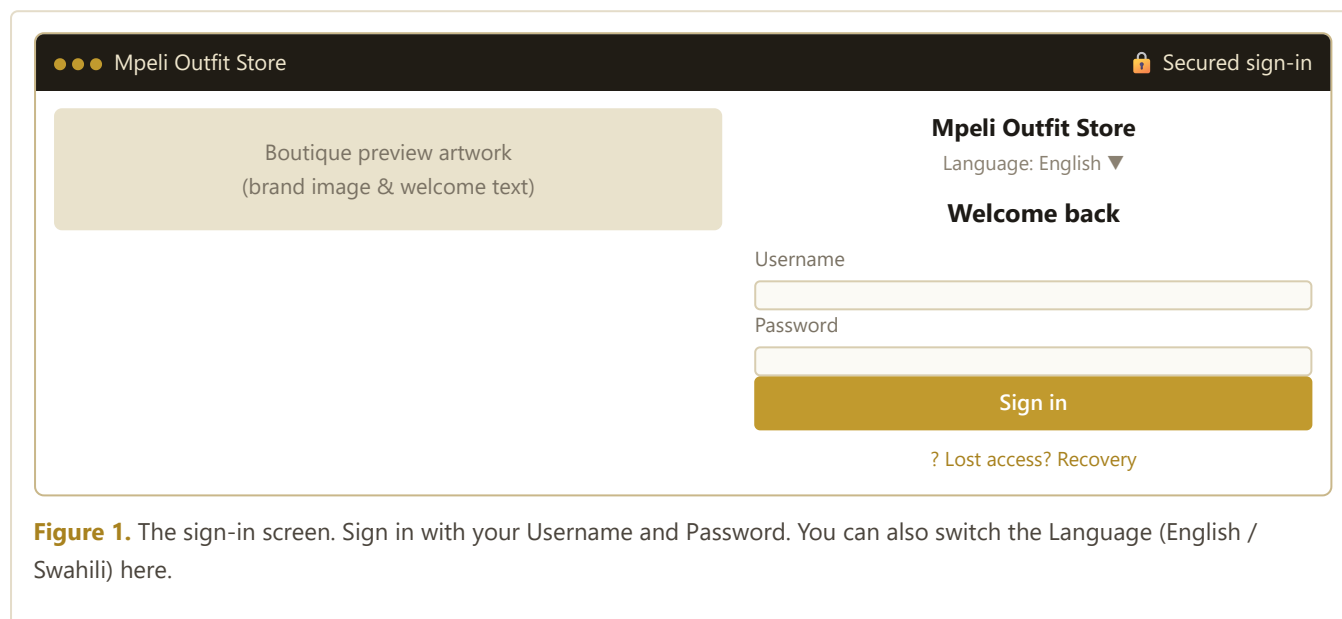


Figure 1. The sign-in screen. Sign in with your Username and Password. You can also switch the Language (English / Swahili) here.

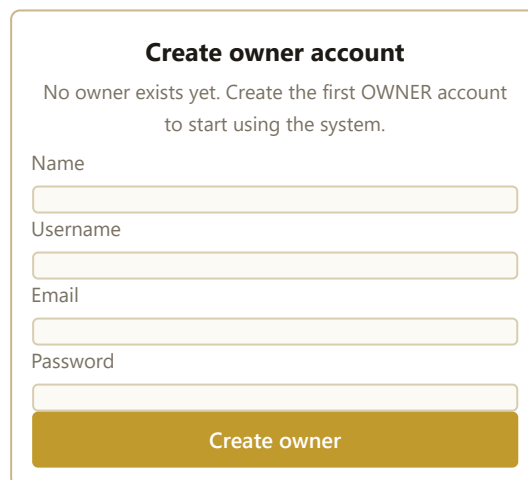
5 First-Time Setup — Creating the Owner Account

The very first time the system is used, no user account exists yet. The first person must create the Owner (admin) account.

Important: This step can only be done **once**. After the Owner account is created, no further "create owner" option is shown, and only the Owner can create additional users.

Steps

1. Open the system. Instead of the normal sign-in form, the **Create owner account** form appears.
2. Enter your details:
 - **Name** — your full name (up to 100 characters).
 - **Username** — the name you will use to sign in. Letters, numbers, and underscore only (up to 50 characters).
 - **Email** — a valid email address (needed for password recovery).
 - **Password** — at least 8 characters, and it must contain at least one letter and one number.
3. Click **Create owner**.
4. You will see the message: "Owner account created. You can now log in."
5. Sign in with your new username and password.



Create owner account

No owner exists yet. Create the first OWNER account to start using the system.

Name

Username

Email

Password

Create owner

Figure 2. The first-owner setup form (shown only when no Owner account exists).

Password rules: A valid password is at least 8 characters long and contains at least one letter and one number (for example `Store2026!`). Keep your password safe — it is needed to recover your account.

6 Signing In

Steps

1. On the sign-in screen, type your **Username** and **Password**.
2. Click **Sign in**.
3. If the details are correct, the dashboard opens. The top bar shows your name and role (**OWNER** or **SELLER**), the store name, a live clock, and an online/offline indicator.

Signing out

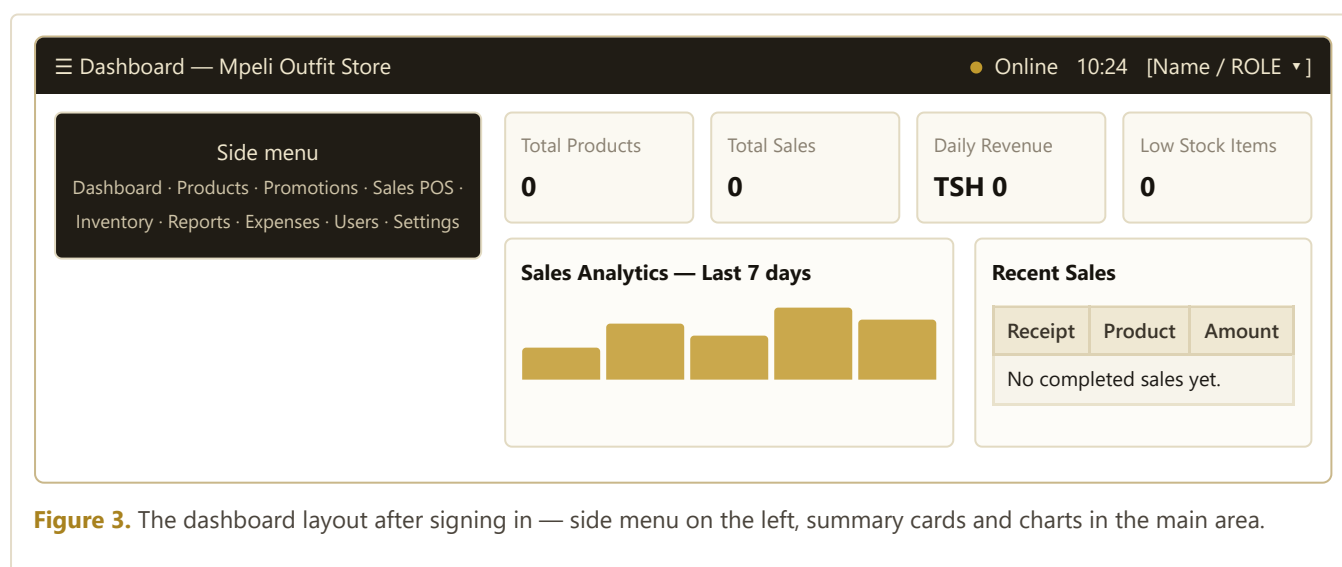
Click your profile area in the top-right corner, then click **Logout**.

What if I cannot sign in?

- **Wrong username or password** — check spelling and try again. For security, the system limits how many failed attempts are allowed in a short period; if you see a "too many attempts" message, wait a few minutes and try again.
- **Forgotten password** — click **Lost access? Recovery** on the sign-in screen (see Section 7).
- **Account disabled** — the Owner may have disabled your account. Contact the Owner.
- **Maintenance mode** — if the Owner switched the system to maintenance, only the Owner can sign in (see Section 18).

Language and theme

Use the **Language** selector (English / Swahili) on the sign-in screen or in the top bar. Use the **moon/sun** button in the top bar to switch between light and dark appearance.



7 Recovering or Changing Your Password

7.1 Recover a forgotten password ALL

If you forget your password, the system lets you reset it in two steps. You will need your **Username** and the **Email** address registered on your account.

1. On the sign-in screen, click **Lost access? Recovery**.
2. **Step 1 — Verify your identity:** enter your Username and Email Address, then click **Verify Identity**.
3. If the details match, the screen advances to Step 2.
4. **Step 2 — Set a new password:** type the new password and confirm it, then click **Reset Password**.
5. You will see *"Password Reset Successfully — You can now log in with your new password."* Click **Back to Login** and sign in.

Please note: New passwords must be at least 8 characters and contain at least one letter and one number. The two password fields must match, and for security, failed recovery attempts are limited per IP address.

7.2 Change your password while signed in ALL

1. Click your profile area in the top-right corner.
2. Choose **Change Password**.
3. Enter your **Current password**, your **New password**, and confirm the new password.
4. Click **Change Password**. On success you will see *"Password changed successfully."*

Tip: Use the eye icon inside the password fields to temporarily show what you are typing.

7.3 View your profile ALL

From the profile menu, choose **View Profile** to see your User ID, username, email, role, and status.

8 The Dashboard

The first page you see after signing in. It gives you a quick snapshot of the shop's performance.

8.1 Summary cards ALL

Top of the dashboard shows live numbers, updated automatically:

Card	Shown to	Meaning
Total Products	All users	Number of active catalog items.
Total Sales	All users	Number of paid receipts recorded.
Daily Revenue	All users	Money received from sales today.
Buying Cost	OWNER	Cost of the goods sold today (what the items cost you to buy).
Daily Gross Profit	OWNER	Today's revenue minus today's buying cost.
Daily Expenses	OWNER	Expenses recorded today.
Daily Net Profit	OWNER	Gross profit minus expenses for today.
Monthly Gross Profit / Expenses / Net Profit	OWNER	Same figures, but for the whole current month.
Low Stock Items	All users	Products at or below the low-stock threshold (default 5 units).

8.2 My Performance SELLER

Sellers see a **My Performance** panel showing their own Sales, Expenses, and Net Profit for This Week, This Month, This Year, and All Time — based only on what they recorded themselves.

8.3 Charts and panels

Panel	Shown to	Description
Sales Analytics (Last 7 days)	All users	Bar chart of sales over the past seven days.
Overview	OWNER	Short summary of live performance.
Profit Trend	OWNER	Bar chart showing the profit trend.
Stock Levels	All users	Bar chart of stock levels across products.
Stock Alerts	All users	List of low-stock items that need restocking.
Recent Sales	All users	Table of the latest paid sales (receipt, product, customer type, amount, status). Owner additionally sees the Profit column.

8.4 Quick actions on the dashboard ALL

- Click **Generate Report** in the top-right of the dashboard to open the report generator (Section 14.3).
- The **Recent Sales** panel lists the latest completed sales with their receipt numbers, amounts, and status.
- The top bar shows the store name, the current time and date, and an **Online** indicator so you always know the system is connected.

Empty state: Before any sales exist, charts show *"No sales data available yet."* and the recent-sales table shows *"No completed sales yet."* This is normal for a brand-new system.

9 Managing Products

The *Products* page (side menu → *Products*) is where the catalog is managed.

9.1 Add a new product OWNER

1. Open the **Products** page and click **Add new product**.
2. Fill in the form:
 - **Product name** — the name of the item.
 - **Buying price (TSH)** — what the item costs you to buy.
 - **Selling price (TSH)** — the normal selling price.
 - **Min allowed selling price (TSH)** — the lowest price you are willing to accept for the item. Discounts can never go below this price.
 - **Stock quantity** — how many units you currently have.
 - **Product image (optional)** — a JPG or PNG photo (maximum 2 MB).
3. Click **Save product**. You will see "Product added successfully."

Image rules: Only **JPG**, **JPEG**, or **PNG** files are accepted, up to 2 MB. Images are automatically resized and converted to the WebP format to keep the catalog fast.

9.2 Edit or delete a product OWNER

Each product card has **Edit** and **Delete** buttons. Click **Edit** to change details (including replacing or removing the image). Click **Delete** to remove the product — the system asks you to confirm before deleting.

9.3 Search and filter ALL

Use the search box to find products by name, color, or size. Owners can also filter by category from the dropdown (**All Categories**).

Pricing reminder: The **selling price** should never be lower than the **minimum allowed selling price**. The system protects your profit by not letting discounts (promotions or bulk) push a price below that minimum.

10 Selling at the Point of Sale (Sales POS)

The Sales page (side menu → Sales POS) is where you complete a customer purchase.

10.1 Build the sale

1. Open the **Sales POS** page.
2. In the **Product Selection** panel, tap the products the customer wants. They move to the **Current Sale** panel on the right.
3. Adjust quantities using the increase/decrease buttons.
4. The **Total** updates automatically. The Owner also sees the expected **Profit** on the sale.

10.2 Bulk discount ALL

- When the cart contains **3 or more items**, the **Bulk customer discount (3+ items)** option becomes available.
- Enter a discount percentage between **1 and 20**.
- The discount applies to the **whole cart**. It does **not** stack with promotions or manual price changes.
- A hint shows how many more items are needed until the discount can be enabled (e.g. "Add 2 more item(s) to enable bulk discount.").

10.3 Complete the sale

1. Choose the **Payment method**: **Cash**, **Card**, or **Mobile Money**.
2. Click **Payment completed**.
3. The system saves the sale, generates a **receipt number**, reduces the stock automatically, and shows "Payment completed. Receipt {number} saved."

Saving rules: A sale can only be saved after at least one product is added ("Add products before completing payment."). The system also prevents duplicate submissions, so clicking once is enough.

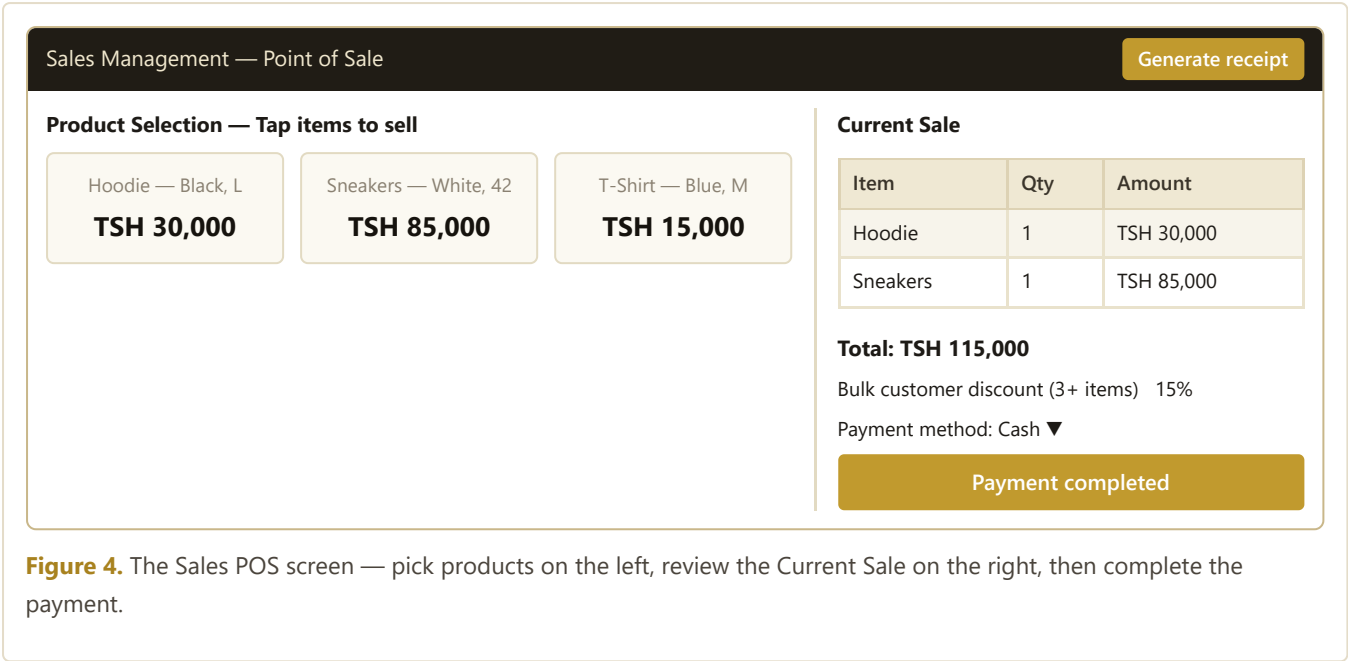


Figure 4. The Sales POS screen — pick products on the left, review the Current Sale on the right, then complete the payment.

11 Promotions OWNER

The *Promotions* page (side menu → *Promotions*, Owners only) lets you run percentage discounts on selected products.

11.1 Create a promotion

1. Open **Promotions** and click **New promotion**.
2. Enter the details:
 - **Promotion name** — e.g. "End of season sale".
 - **Description (optional)**.
 - **Discount %** — between 1 and 100.
 - **Start date** and **Start time (optional)**.
 - **End date** and **End time (optional)**.
 - **Apply to all products**, or select specific products.
3. Click **Save promotion**. You will see "Promotion created successfully."

11.2 Promotion statuses

Status	Meaning
Draft	Created but not yet live for sellers.
Scheduled	Activated, but its start date/time has not arrived yet.
Active	Live now — sellers see the discounted prices automatically.
Inactive	Turned off manually.
Expired	The end date/time has passed.

11.3 Activate and deactivate

- Use the **Activate** button to make a promotion live for sellers.
- Use the **Deactivate** button to stop it immediately.
- Editing and deleting are done with the Edit / Delete controls. Deleting a promotion does **not** affect sales that were already completed.

How discounts are applied: The discounted selling price is the normal selling price minus the promotion percentage, but it is **never below the product's minimum allowed selling price**. Only the Owner can create or manage promotions; Sellers simply see the discounted prices on products.

12

Inventory OWNER

The *Inventory* page (side menu → *Inventory, Owners only*) is your stock room overview.

What you see

Section	Description
Remaining Stock	Total units available across all sizes of every product.
Low Stock	Items at or below the low-stock threshold (default 5 units) — flagged for restock review.
Out of Stock	Items with zero available units.
All Products Stock	The complete list of products with their current stock levels.
Low stock warning	Details of items that need restocking.
Out of stock	Details of items currently unavailable.

How stock changes: Stock decreases automatically after each sale and increases when you adjust the stock quantity on the product. The low-stock threshold can be changed in Settings (Section 16).

13 Recording Expenses

The *Expenses* page (side menu → *Expenses*) tracks shop costs so you always know where money goes.

13.1 Record an expense ALL

1. Open the **Expenses** page and click **Record expense**.
2. Choose the **Expense category** from this list: **Food, Transport, Rent, TRA, Electricity, Water, Salary, Maintenance, Other**.
3. If you chose **Other**, an **Expense name** field appears and is required.
4. Optionally add a **Description**.
5. Enter the **Amount** and the **Date** (the date cannot be in the future).
6. Click **Save expense**. You will see "Expense recorded successfully."

13.2 Expense summary ALL

The panel next to the form shows **Today** and **This Month** totals, plus **Today's Expenses by Category**.

13.3 Who sees what

Role	Visibility
OWNER	Sees all expenses recorded by anyone in the shop, and can delete expenses.
SELLER	Sees only the expenses they recorded themselves, and can record new expenses.

Duplicate protection: The system automatically prevents the same expense from being saved twice by mistake.

14 Reports and Analytics

The *Reports* page (side menu → Reports) shows performance figures and lets you download them as a professional PDF or Excel file.

14.1 On-screen summaries ALL

- **Daily Sales, Weekly Reports, and Monthly Reports** — sales totals for today, the last 7 days, and this month.
- **Revenue Charts** — a monthly revenue line chart.
- **Best Selling Products** — the items that sell the most.

14.2 Financial summaries OWNER

Owners additionally see **Daily Financial**, **Monthly Financial**, and **Yearly Financial** cards with **Revenue**, **Buying Cost**, **Gross Profit**, **Expenses**, and **Net Profit**, plus the **Expense Breakdown**.

14.3 Generate and download a report ALL

Click the **Generate Report** button (on the Dashboard or the Reports page). A three-step wizard opens:

1. **Step 1 — Period:** choose **Today**, **This Week (rolling 7 days)**, **This Month**, **This Year**, or **Custom Range** (custom ranges need both a start and an end date).
2. **Step 2 — Content:** choose **General (all sections)** or **Choose sections**. Owners can pick from Sales, Revenue, Expenses, Profit, Purchases/Stock In, Inventory, Stock Movement, Seller Performance, Customers, Transactions, and Products. Sellers can pick Sales, Revenue, Expenses, and Transactions.
3. **Step 3 — Format:** choose **PDF (A4 report)** or **Excel (XLSX)**, then click **Generate & Download**.

Generate Report

1 · Period — 2 · Content — 3 · Format

Select period

This Month ▼

☒ General (all sections) ☐ Choose sections

☒ PDF (A4 report) ☐ Excel (XLSX)

Generate & Download

Figure 5. The three-step report generator — Period, Content, and Format.

PDF vs Excel: The PDF is a ready-to-print A4 report. The Excel file opens in Microsoft Excel or Google Sheets with a Summary sheet plus one sheet per selected section.

15 Managing Users **OWNER**

The *Users* page (side menu → *Users*, Owners only) lets you create accounts for employees and control their access.

15.1 Register an employee

1. Open **Users** and fill in the **Register employee** form: **Name**, **Username**, **Email**, and **Password**.
2. New employees are always registered as **SELLER**.
3. Click **Create user**. You will see "Employee created successfully."

15.2 Manage employees

The **Employees** table lists Name, Username, Role, Status, and Actions. From here you can:

- **Edit** an employee's details (including setting a new password — leave it blank to keep the current one).
- **Disable** an account to block sign-in, or **Enable** it again later.

Security note: Never share your password. Each employee should have their own account so sales and expenses are correctly attributed to the person who recorded them.

16

Settings

OWNER

The *Settings* page (side menu → *Settings, Owners only*) controls shop information and system preferences.

16.1 Shop information

Shop name, **Shop address**, and **Shop phone** — these are used across the system (for example, on receipts).

16.2 Admin profile

Admin full name, **Admin email**, and **Admin password** — updates the Owner account's profile. Changing the password here requires entering a new password value.

16.3 System preferences

Preference	Description
Dark mode	Switch the whole interface to a dark appearance.
Low stock alerts	Enable or disable low-stock warnings.
Receipt printing	Enable or disable receipt printing.
Low stock threshold	The stock level (default 5) below which an item counts as "low stock".
Receipt footer	Extra text printed at the bottom of receipts (e.g. "Thank you for shopping!").

16.4 Maintenance mode

When **Maintenance Mode** is enabled, only Owners can sign in — everyone else sees a maintenance screen. You can set the **Maintenance message** shown to other users, then click **Save maintenance settings**.

Note: After changing settings, click **Save Settings** at the bottom of the page. You will see "*Settings saved successfully.*"

17 Session and Security Behavior

These behaviors protect your shop's data. Understanding them helps avoid surprises during the day.

17.1 Automatic sign-out (inactivity)

- If you stop using the system, a warning appears after **3 minutes** of inactivity: "Your session is about to expire."
- You have **60 seconds** to click **Continue Session**. If you do nothing, you are signed out for your safety.
- A signed-in session lasts up to **24 hours** in total, after which you must sign in again.

Tip: Click **Continue Session** when the warning appears to stay signed in. Real activity (like adding a product or recording a sale) also keeps your session alive.

17.2 Password and sign-in rules

- Passwords must be at least **8 characters** and contain at least one letter and one number.
- Usernames can contain letters, numbers, and underscores only (up to 50 characters).
- After too many failed sign-in attempts, the system temporarily blocks further attempts from the same address. Wait a few minutes before trying again.
- Passwords are stored securely; even the system never shows you your password back.

17.3 Data protection

- Sales and expenses are protected against accidental duplicate entry.
- Stock is reduced automatically inside the same secure step as saving the sale, so a sale always matches its stock change.
- Product images are validated and limited in size, so no oversized files can be uploaded.

18 Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to do
I cannot sign in (wrong username/password).	Check spelling. If you get a "too many attempts" message, wait a few minutes. Use Lost access? Recovery if you forgot the password.
I forgot my password.	Click Lost access? Recovery , verify with your username and email, then set a new password (Section 7.1).
The screen says "Your session is about to expire."	Click Continue Session within 60 seconds. If it expired, sign in again.
I see a "Under Maintenance" screen.	The Owner has enabled maintenance mode. Only the Owner can sign in now. Wait until maintenance is finished.
I see the "System Health Check" screen with failed checks.	The server is not fully configured (e.g. database or PHP issue). Contact the person who hosts the system. Click Retry after the issue is fixed.
My account is disabled.	Contact the Owner. They can re-enable the account on the Users page.
I cannot upload a product image.	Use a JPG, JPEG, or PNG file smaller than 2 MB. The system will tell you the exact reason.
The bulk discount is greyed out.	Add at least 3 items to the cart — the hint tells you how many more items are needed.
I cannot save a sale.	Make sure at least one product is in the Current Sale and a payment method is selected.
Charts show "No sales data available yet."	This is normal before any sales are recorded. The figures fill in automatically as sales are made.
The report download does not start.	Check your browser's download settings and pop-up blockers. Try again with Generate & Download .
The system feels slow.	Refresh the page. If it is still slow, contact the person hosting the system.

19 Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. What is the difference between Gross Profit and Net Profit?

Gross profit = money received from sales minus what those items cost you (buying cost). **Net profit** = gross profit minus your expenses (rent, salaries, transport, etc.).

Q2. Can a Seller create another user account?

No. Only the **Owner** can create, edit, or disable user accounts (Users page).

Q3. Can a Seller manage promotions?

No. Promotions are created and managed only by the **Owner**. Sellers automatically see the discounted prices when a promotion is active.

Q4. Can I change the currency used by the system?

The default currency is **TSH**. Currency is controlled in the system settings by the Owner (Section 16).

Q5. What happens to stock when I complete a sale?

The stock is reduced automatically and instantly by the quantity sold. The Inventory page always reflects the latest levels.

Q6. Can a discount go below my cost?

No. Every product has a **minimum allowed selling price**. Promotions and bulk discounts never push the selling price below that minimum.

Q7. Do promotions affect sales already completed?

No. Completed sales are never changed, even if a promotion is edited, deactivated, or deleted afterwards.

Q8. I accidentally recorded a wrong expense. Can I fix it?

If you are the Owner, you can delete the expense from the Recent Expenses table. As a Seller, ask the Owner to delete it, then record it correctly.

Q9. What happens if two people try to sell the last item at the same time?

The system checks stock at the moment the sale is saved and handles it safely, so the same item cannot be over-sold.

Q10. Why did the system sign me out even though I was still working?

Sessions expire after **24 hours** or after **3 minutes** of inactivity. Just sign in again to continue.

Q11. Can I use the system on my phone?

Yes. The interface is responsive and works on smaller screens, though a tablet or computer gives the most comfortable experience.

20 Glossary

Term	Meaning
Buying price	What an item costs you to purchase from a supplier.
Selling price	The normal price at which you sell an item.
Minimum allowed selling price	The lowest price at which you are willing to sell an item — discounts cannot go below it.
Bulk discount	A percentage discount applied to the whole cart when it contains 3 or more items (1–20%).
Promotion	A percentage discount on selected products that runs between a start and an end date/time.
Receipt	The document generated when a sale is completed, identified by its receipt number.
POS	Point of Sale — the screen used to complete customer purchases.
Gross profit	Revenue minus buying cost of the goods sold.
Net profit	Gross profit minus expenses.
Expense	A recorded shop cost, categorized (e.g. Rent, Transport, Electricity, Salary).
Inventory / Stock	The quantity of each product available to sell.
Low-stock threshold	The stock level (default 5) below which an item is flagged as low stock.
Owner	The administrator role with full access to the system.
Seller	An employee role that records sales and its own expenses.
Maintenance mode	A state in which only the Owner can sign in; other users see a maintenance screen.
TSH	Tanzanian Shilling — the default currency code used in the system.
PDF / XLSX	File formats for exported reports — a printable document and an Excel workbook.

Need more help? For questions not covered here, contact the Owner or the person who maintains the Mpeli Outfit Store system. Only verified information about the actual system has been included in this guide.